Project Design Phase

Problem - Solution Fit Template

Date	2 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Problem - Solution Fit:

Problem-solution fit is reached when you have identified a problem your customer really has and can show that your solution solves it. It helps you understand your customers' situation, notice the behaviors that cause their problem, and confirm the solution matches their needs before the team starts building.

Purpose: Solve complex problems in a way that suits your customers' circumstances. Succeed sooner by understanding present situations and behavior. Raise the sense of urgency and stay aligned with customer needs. Improve adoption by designing for the way people already work.

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer.

Template

1. Customer segment(s)

- New joiners and existing staff who need a standard laptop
- Managers who approve laptop requests for their teams
- IT procurement coordinators who fulfil the orders

2. Jobs-to-be-done / problems

Jobs to be done

- Receive an approved laptop fast and follow its status
- Approve requests without delay
- Fulfil orders correctly

Problems

- Manual approvals, no visibility of status, repeated data entry

3. Triggers to act

- A new hire is about to start
- A laptop reaches its refresh cycle
- A device is lost, damaged or too slow
- A growing team needs more devices

4. Emotions: before / after

Before

- Anxious, frustrated and unsure whether the request is moving

After

- Relieved, confident and in control, with clear status and a laptop that arrives on time

5. Available solutions

- Email requests and spreadsheets: familiar, yet slow and error-prone
- Generic catalog with manual approvals: still requires chasing
- Manual stock checks and purchase orders: eat up IT time

6. Customer constraints

- Budget limits for each cost center
- Approval and security policies
- Limited stock and vendor lead times
- Little IT staff time for routine work

7. Behaviour

• Employees email IT or their manager to ask for status

• Managers hold back approvals when busy or when details are missing

• Coordinators check inventory and raise orders manually

Related behaviour

• Raising follow-up tickets and asking colleagues for help

8. Channels of behaviour

Online

• Employee portal and service catalog

• Email and mobile approvals

Offline

• Phone calls and in-person follow-ups with IT or the manager

9. Problem root cause

• Requests rely on manual hand-offs between people and systems

• No automated rules exist for standard requests

• There is no single view of request status

10. Your solution

• One standard laptop catalog item in ServiceNow

• Flow Designer automates approval, stock check, purchase order and asset record

• Automatic notifications and a status view for the employee

• Dashboard showing turnaround time and savings

Fit check: every part of the solution answers a root cause. Automated rules take the place of manual hand-offs, notifications take the place of status chasing, and a single catalog item takes the place of scattered email requests.

Implementation Screenshots (ServiceNow)

Captured from the project demo video: Flow Designer build and a test laptop request.

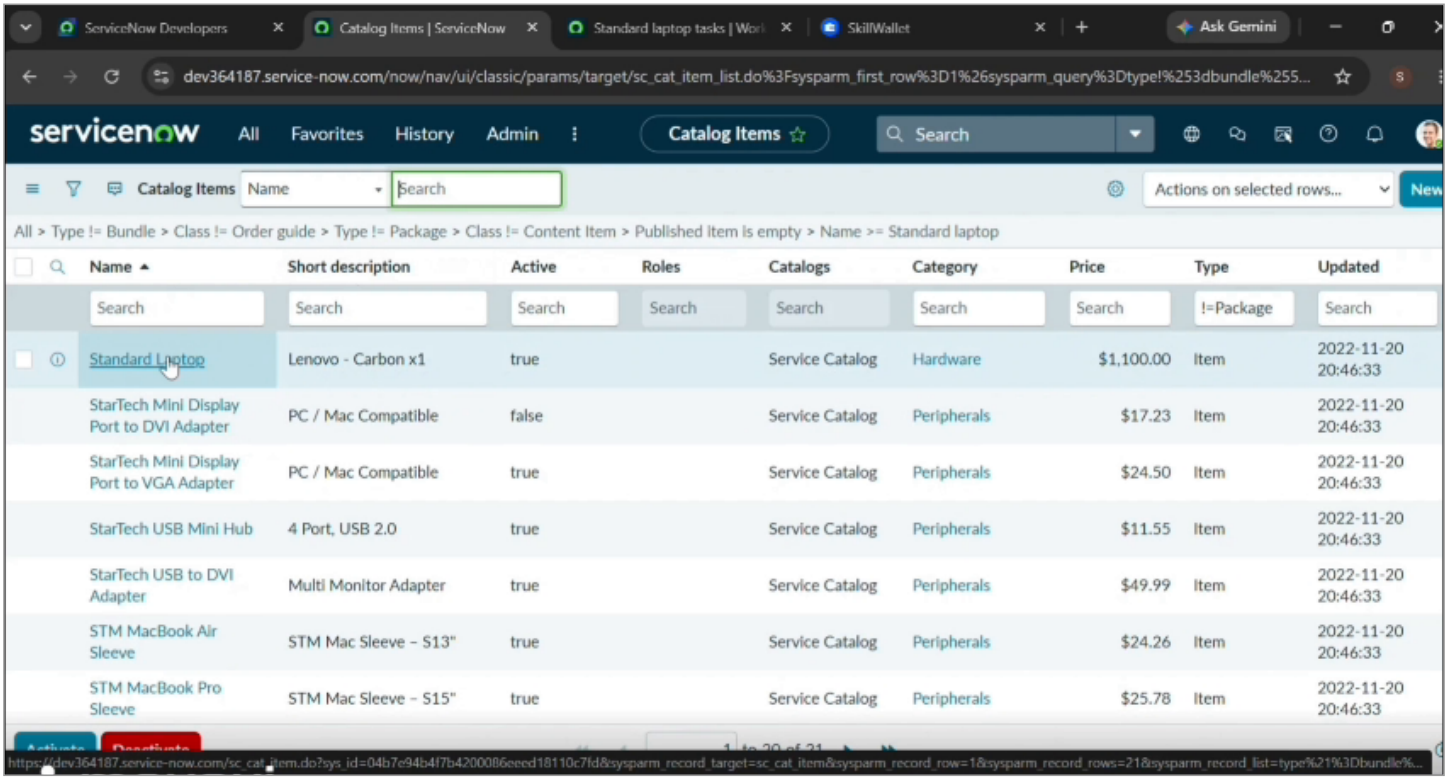


Figure 1: Catalog item "Standard Laptop" (Lenovo Carbon x1) in the catalog

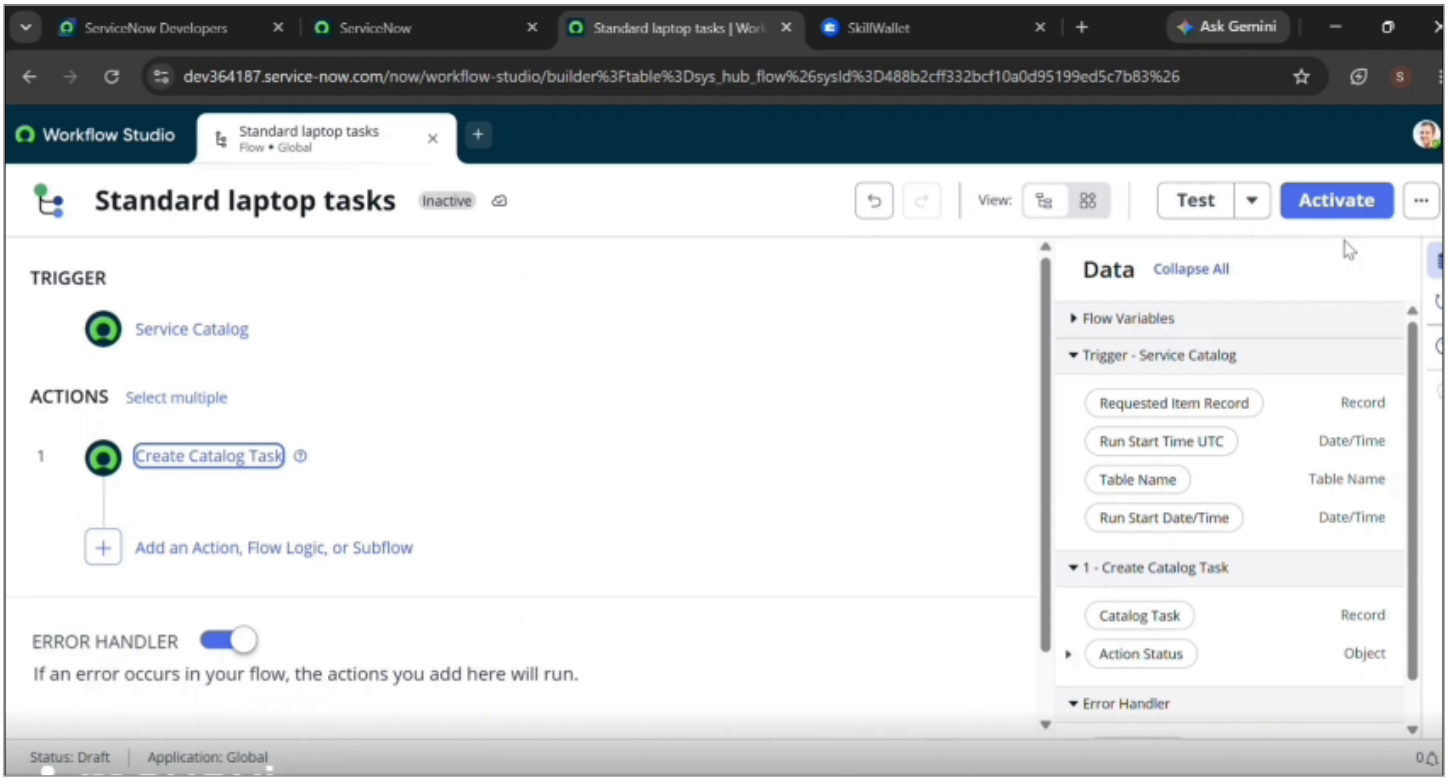


Figure 2: Flow Designer: Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action